

ANOTHER SUICIDE ADDS TO THE UP GOVERNMENT'S REPUTATION FOR CORRUPTION

LUCKNOW | Suicide Scandal

The suicide of an assistant general manager in the state's Provincial Cooperative Federation (PCF) has once again brought the Uttar Pradesh Government's notorious reputation for corruption into the spotlight. Last week, Syed Gayas Ahmed hung himself in a room, leaving behind a suicide note stating that the managing director, additional managing director and the general manager had been pressuring him to "give them bribes". Ahmed's note says that he first gave them money from his salary and then collected a few thousand rupees from his juniors. The sp

GAGAN JAIN



GRIEVING RELATIVES CARRY AHMED'S BODY

resident, Mulayam Singh Yadav, in turn, has held Chief Minister Mayawati responsible for the suicide and said she was forcing officers to cough out money for her. *by Subhash Mishra*

Shining Stars

After discovering ultra-violet resistant bacteria 40 km high in the sky, the country's scientific community had yet another reason to celebrate after some celestial bodies were named after Indian scientists.

Asteroids Gokumenon (after MGK Menon) and Bhattacharyya (Professor J.C.

Bhattacharya) now join (4130) Ramanujan 1988 DQ1, (2596) Vainu Bappu 1979 KN, (2986) Mrinalini 2525 P-L and (2987) Sarabhai 4583 P-L in the sky. The names were given by the International Astronomical Union in Germany recently.

by Stephen David

SUVASHIS MULLICK



GANGULY WITH SHAH RUKH

KOLKATA | Silly Points

When he isn't on the field, Sourav Ganguly makes for a prankster's delight. Recently his Kolkata Knight Riders (KKR) boss Shah Rukh Khan, playing on the feud over captaincy between KKR coach John Buchanan and Ganguly, asked the left-hander, "I'd love to play. Why don't you become my coach?" Sourav's reply was instant: "I'm always willing to discuss coaching. We shall talk about it later." There's more. Thronged by newsmen at the airport as he left for South Africa for the IPL offshore season, Ganguly had to rush back to his car after checking in because he thought he had left his wallet behind. When he returned, daughter Sana joked, "April Fool, Baba." Comeback man, indeed. *by Abhijit Dasgupta*

MUMBAI | Black Listed

THE RITU BERI-DESIGNED NEW AIR INDIA UNIFORM RAN INTO TROUBLE WITH SOME CREW MEMBERS OVER THE LIBERAL USE OF BLACK THAT DIDN'T SUIT ALL SKIN TONES.

It appears that designer wear is just not good enough for Air India crew. While designer Ritu Beri was roped in to design the new uniform for its cabin crew and ground staff, the makeover is not going down too well with the cabin crew, particularly those from the south. Stewardesses from Chennai, Hyderabad and Bangalore have raised an objection to the black liberally used in Beri's initial designs. They say the uniforms do not complement their dark skin tones. Married women, especially from Tamil Nadu, have refused to wear black because it is considered inauspicious. Jitendra Bhargava, executive director (communications), Air India, however, is in denial mode. "The new uniforms are already being worn by crew members in the south," he says.

by Swati Mathur



RAVI S SAHANI

A CABIN CREW MEMBER IN THE OLD UNIFORM (LEFT); A SKETCH OF THE NEW UNIFORM (RIGHT)

